

ARCHITECT

JOB DESCRIPTION

An architect plans and designs buildings for a range of clients, from companies developing huge retail or leisure facilities to individuals building their own homes. Architects may design new buildings, work on existing structures, or specialize in the restoration and conservation of historic sites. They are responsible for ensuring buildings are designed to comply with national, state, and local building codes.

SALARY

Newly qualified architect ★★☆☆☆

Senior architect ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Employment opportunities linked to the state of construction industry • Rising demand for architects due to growth in housing market • Fierce competition in the private sector

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Art • Design • Construction • Design technology • Materials science • Engineering • Physics • Mathematics



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS A degree followed by at least a two-year apprenticeship and licensing exams are required for entry.



LIFESTYLE Architects may work regular office hours, but more often than not, project deadlines demand longer hours.



LOCATION While the work is mainly office-based, architects also travel to construction sites to meet with clients and assess progress.



THE REALITIES Markets can be affected by changes in the economy. Pay can vary greatly between the public and private sectors.

CAREER PATHS

It takes a long time to qualify as an architect. You need to gain practical experience after completing a degree in architecture, after which you take a set of exams to earn professional accreditation. Once qualified, your progress depends on your reputation and field of activity. Large architectural practices offer opportunities for promotion, but many architects choose to set up their own business, or to take jobs with property developers or local authorities.

DISTANCE LEARNING STUDENT

You may be able to study by distance learning to gain professional accreditation as an architect. To become an architect, you need an accredited undergraduate degree.



GRADUATE An architecture degree can take up to five years, after which you will need to work and learn under professional supervision before registering as a qualified architect.

